(2) Remove the instrument panel (Refer to 23 - BODY/INSTRUMENT PANEL/INSTRUMENT PANEL ASSEMBLY - REMOVAL).

(3) If the vehicle is not equipped with A/C, go to Step 6. If the vehicle is equipped with A/C, recover the refrigerant from the refrigerant system (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - STANDARD PROCEDURE - REFRIGERANT SYSTEM RECOVERY).

(4) Disconnect the A/C liquid and suction lines from the A/C evaporator and remove and discard the O-ring seals (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING/REFRIGERANT LINE COUPLER - REMOVAL).

(5) Install plugs in, or tape over the opened suction and liquid line fittings and both evaporator tubes.

(6) Drain the engine cooling system (Refer to 7 - COOLING - STANDARD PROCEDURE).

(7) Disconnect the heater hoses from the heater core tubes. Install plugs in, or tape over the opened heater core tubes.

(8) Disconnect the HVAC system vacuum supply line connector from the tee fitting near the heater core tubes.

(9) Remove the five nuts that secure the HVAC housing to the dash panel in the engine compartment (Fig. 8). If necessary, loosen the battery hold-downs and reposition the battery for additional access (Refer to 8 - ELECTRICAL/BATTERY SYSTEM/BATTERY - REMOVAL).

(10) Remove the two push-nuts that secure the defroster duct to the dash panel in the passenger compartment and remove the duct.

(11) Remove the bolt that secures the HVAC housing to the bracket located on the dash panel in the passenger compartment.

(12) Remove the HVAC housing from inside the vehicle taking care not to allow any remaining coolant to drain on the vehicles interior.

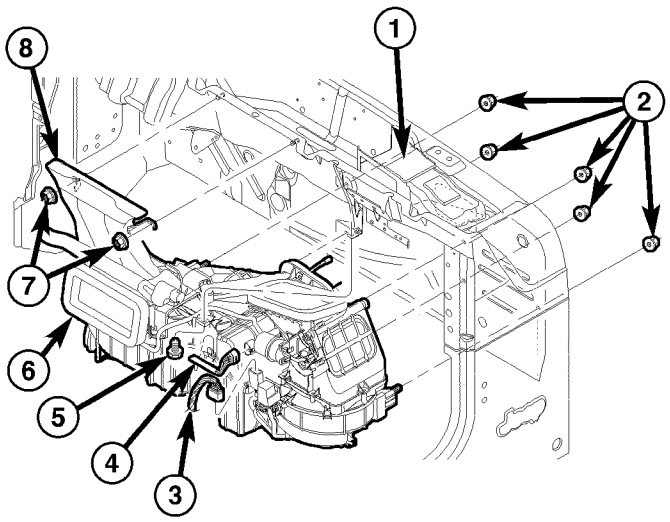

Fig. 8 HVAC Housing - LHD shown, RHD similar

1 - DASH PANEL
2 - NUT (5)
3 - INSTRUMENT PANEL WIRE HARNESS
4 - INSTRUMENT PANEL VACUUM HARHESS
5 - BOLT
6 - HVAC HOUSING
7 - NUT (2)
8 - DEFROSTER DUCT

AIR INLET HOUSING

WARNING: Refer to the applicable warnings and cautions for this system before performing the following operation (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - WARNINGS) and (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - CAUTIONS). Failure to follow the warnings and cautions could result in possible personal injury or death.

WARNING: On vehicles equipped with airbags, disable the airbag system before attempting any steering wheel, steering column, or instrument panel component diagnosis or service. Disconnect and isolate the negative battery (ground) cable, then wait two minutes for the airbag system capacitor to discharge before performing further diagnosis or service. This is the only sure way to disable the airbag system. Failure to take the proper precautions could result in accidental airbag deployment and possible personal injury or death.

NOTE: The recirculation-air door and actuator are used only on models equipped with A/C.

NOTE: The air inlet housing must be removed from HVAC housing and disassembled for service of the recirculation-air door.